



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

abhyuddhṛta+prajvalita+agni+hotraṃ |
kṛta+abhiṣeka+ṛṣi+jana+avakīrṇam |
jāpya+svana+ākūjita+deva+koṣṭhaṃ* |
dharmasya karma+antam iva pravṛttam || 7.33 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 7, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Buddhacarita paints a vivid picture of the spiritual landscape the young Siddhartha was leaving behind. It describes a scene vibrant with religious activity: the sacred fires of the Agnihotra ritual blazing brightly, learned hermits performing ablutions, the chanting of mantras echoing from temple sanctuaries. It speaks of a world saturated with the pursuit of dharma, a world seemingly at the very culmination of righteous action. Yet, this very image, so rich in spiritual practice, becomes the backdrop against which Siddhartha's profound renunciation gains even greater significance.

The verse doesn't condemn these practices. Instead, it highlights their limitations. Siddhartha, despite being surrounded by such fervent devotion, recognized an incompleteness, a lack of ultimate liberation within the established traditions. He saw that while rituals and asceticism could purify the mind and perhaps lead to temporary states of bliss, they didn't address the root cause of suffering. His departure, therefore, wasn't a rejection of spirituality, but a quest for a deeper, more transformative truth.

For you today, this verse can be a powerful reminder. How often do you find yourself caught up in the rituals and routines of your own life, believing that simply performing the expected actions will lead to fulfillment? Perhaps you diligently pursue career goals, accumulate possessions, or strive for social approval, hoping that these endeavors will bring you lasting happiness. The Buddhacarita invites you to examine whether these activities, like the Agnihotra fires, are truly illuminating your path or simply providing a temporary glow. It encourages you to look beyond the surface, to question the conventional wisdom, and to seek a more profound understanding of yourself and the world around you. Just as Siddhartha sought liberation beyond the confines of tradition, you too can embark on your own journey of self-discovery, seeking a truth that resonates deeply within your heart.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly fulfilled by the rituals you perform daily, or are you simply seeking external validation instead of inner peace?